

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-I.4: The Third Declension

Recover third-declension stems and choose consonant-stem, i-stem, and neuter forms from dictionary evidence and syntax

Stage	Stage I — Foundations
Prerequisite	EL-I.3 mastery: control first- and second-declension paradigms, neuters, and vocatives
Next	EL-I.5, Fourth and Fifth Declensions

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Unit 4: The Third Declension

On completing this unit, you can:

- derive a third-declension stem from the genitive singular;
- decline consonant-stem and i-stem masculine, feminine, and neuter nouns;
- apply the neuter and i-stem rules; and
- parse common third-declension liturgical vocabulary in phrases.

1.1 Stem first, then endings

Third-declension nominatives are unpredictable. The genitive singular always ends in *-is*; remove that ending to find the working stem. Thus *rex, regis* gives *reg-*; *nomen, nominis* gives *nomi-*; *altare, altaris* gives *altar-*.

<i>rex, regis m.</i>			<i>nomen, nominis n.</i>		<i>altare, altaris n. (i-stem)</i>	
sg.	pl.		sg.	pl.	sg.	pl.
Nom.	rex	reges	nomen	nomina	altare	altaria
Gen.	regis	regum	nominis	nominum	altaris	altarium
Dat.	regi	regibus	nomini	nominibus	altari	altaribus
Acc.	regem	reges	nomen	nomina	altare	altaria
Abl.	rege	regibus	nomine	nominibus	altari	altaribus
Voc.	rex	reges	nomen	nomina	altare	altaria

An **i-stem** is a third-declension subtype that uses a characteristic *i* in certain case endings; a **consonant stem** uses the ordinary third-declension endings without that characteristic *i*. Masculine and feminine i-stems normally have genitive plural *-ium*; neuter i-stems have ablative singular *-i*, nominative/accusative plural *-ia*, and genitive plural *-ium*. A useful neuter i-stem test is a nominative in *-e*, *-al*, or *-ar*. Consonant-stem neuters retain plural *-a* and genitive plural *-um*. Dictionaries should be consulted where stem classification is uncertain.

Worked example: *Introibo ad altare Dei* (Ps 42:4)

Worked passage ID: *W.I.12*; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

introibo is future, “I shall go in”. *ad* governs the accusative; neuter *altare* is therefore accusative singular even though it looks like the nominative. *Dei* is genitive singular, “of God”. Translation: “I shall go unto the altar of God.”

Worked example: *Pax hominibus bonæ voluntatis*

Worked passage ID: W.I.13; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

pax, *pacis* *f.* is nominative singular. *hominibus*, from *homo*, *hominis* *m.*, is dative plural. *voluntatis*, from *voluntas*, *voluntatis* *f.*, is genitive singular. Translation: “Peace to people of good will.” Three different third-declension stems are recoverable only from their genitives.

Worked example: *Corpus Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam meam*

Worked passage ID: W.I.14; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

corpus, *corporis* *n.* is nominative singular and subject of *custodiat*. The chain *Domini nostri Iesu Christi* modifies *corpus*; its central nouns are genitive. *animam meam* is accusative singular object. Translation: “May the Body of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve my soul.”

Worked example: *In nomine Patris, et Filii, et Spiritus Sancti*

Worked passage ID: W.I.15; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

in takes ablative *nomine*, from *nomen*, *nominis* *n.* The coordinated possessors *Patris*, *Filii*, and *Spiritus Sancti* are genitive singular. Translation: “In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit.”

1.2 Handwritten study and controlled composition

Copy the three paradigms. Beside each form, write its stem and ending separated by a vertical line, except for the nominative singular. Make a ten-card stack with nominative and genitive on the front and stem, gender, and meaning on the back: *pax*, *pater*, *homo*, *nomen*, *corpus*, *altare*, *civitas*, *voluntas*, *lux*, *rex*. Compose *Rex custodit civitatem*, “the king guards the city”; make the kings and cities plural, *Reges custodiunt civitates*; then write “the name of the king”, *nomen regis*.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 Stem first, then endings — transfer practice

Connection. A fixed stem-recovery ladder prevents the nominative from being mistaken for the inflectional base.

Transfer task. For each of the lesson's ten review nouns, write four lines: dictionary pair, genitive with *-is* divided off, recovered stem, and the consonant-stem or i-stem decision with evidence.

Retrieval check. Without notes, state the neuter i-stem plural and genitive-plural endings and the evidence required before using them.

1.2 Handwritten study and controlled composition — transfer practice

Connection. A stem is mastered when it survives number, case, and clause-role changes.

Transfer task. Perform the lesson's king/city transformations, marking the recovered stem under every form and labeling the syntactic reason for each ending. Then make a one-line i-stem card for one lesson noun.

Retrieval check. Explain why identical final letters in two forms do not guarantee identical case or number.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Unit 4: Third Declension

Worksheet I.13 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.13

Focus: Stem recovery, consonant stems, i-stems, and liturgical syntax**Use:** Derive each stem from the genitive before choosing an ending.

1. Derive the stem and state gender for *rex, regis m.*; *pax, pacis f.*; *nomen, nominis n.*; *corpus, corporis n.*; *altare, altaris n.*; *lux, lucis f.*

-
2. Give accusative singular, genitive plural, and dative/ablative plural of *rex, regis m.*

-
3. Give nominative/accusative plural and genitive plural of consonant-stem *nomen* and i-stem *altare*; state the contrasting rule.

-
4. Translate and parse *ad altare Dei*.

-
5. Correct *in nominem Patris*, intended “in the name of the Father”.

-
6. **Text:** *Pax hominibus bonæ voluntatis*.

Passage ID: I.13.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Recover every third-declension dictionary form, parse the printed forms, and translate.

Worksheet I.16 — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** I.16**Focus:** Stem-first production and syntax-driven parsing**Use:** Equivalent assessment with a different vocabulary set.

1. From *homo, hominis m.; civitas, civitatis f.; mors, mortis f.; sacerdos, sacerdotis m.; sanguis, sanguinis m.*, derive each stem.
-

2. Give accusative singular and plural, genitive plural, and ablative singular of *civitas, civitatis f.*
-

3. Apply the neuter rule to *corpus, corporis n.*: give accusative singular, nominative plural, accusative plural, and genitive plural.
-

4. Translate “the name of the king”, “peace to the people”, and “at the altars”.
-

5. Correct the two ending errors in *Lux perpetuum luceat eis*.
-

6. **Text:** *Introibo ad altare Dei, ad Deum qui lætificat iuventutem meam.*

Passage ID: I.16.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse *altare, Dei, Deum*, and *iuventutem*; resolve the case of *qui*; translate.

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Derive at least eleven of twelve supplied stems and genders correctly, commit no neuter-rule error, and parse at least 16 of 18 contextual third-declension forms with a stated reason for every i-stem form.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-I.5, Fourth and Fifth Declensions.

If it is not met: Worksheets I.14 and I.15 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

Stem first, then endings — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Each stem must come from the genitive rather than a guessed nominative. A complete i-stem card gives neuter nominative/accusative plural *-ia* and genitive plural *-ium*, while requiring the lesson's dictionary and stem-pattern evidence rather than semantics alone.

Handwritten study and controlled composition — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The transformation must preserve the lexical stems and change only forms required by the new number or role. The i-stem card must state the diagnostic and relevant ending. The retrieval answer must appeal to the whole ending, declensional class, agreement, government, and clause context.

CHAPTER 2

Unit 4: Third Declension

Solution I.13 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.13

Focus: Stem recovery, consonant stems, i-stems, and liturgical syntax

Use: Derive each stem from the genitive before choosing an ending.

1. Derive the stem and state gender for *rex, regis m.*; *pax, pacis f.*; *nomen, nominis n.*; *corpus, corporis n.*; *altare, altaris n.*; *lux, lucis f.*

Answer / model: *reg-*, masculine; *pac-*, feminine; *nomin-*, neuter; *corpor-*, neuter; *altar-*, neuter; *luc-*, feminine.

2. Give accusative singular, genitive plural, and dative/ablative plural of *rex, regis m.*

Answer / model: *regem, regum, regibus.*

3. Give nominative/accusative plural and genitive plural of consonant-stem *nomen* and i-stem *altare*; state the contrasting rule.

Answer / model: *nomina, nominum; altaria, altarium.* Neuter consonant stems use *-a/-um*; neuter i-stems use *-ia/-ium*.

4. Translate and parse *ad altare Dei*.

Answer / model: *ad* governs neuter singular accusative *altare*; *Dei* is masculine singular genitive. “to the altar of God”.

5. Correct *in nominem Patris*, intended “in the name of the Father”.

Answer / model: *in nomine Patris*. Here *in* denotes location or state and governs ablative *nomine*; *Patris* is genitive singular.

6. **Text:** *Pax hominibus bonæ voluntatis.*

Passage ID: I.13.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Recover every third-declension dictionary form, parse the printed forms, and translate.

Answer / notes: *pax, pacis f.*: nominative singular; *homo, hominis m.*: *hominibus*, dative plural; *voluntas, voluntatis f.*: *voluntatis*, genitive singular. *bonæ* agrees with *voluntatis*. “Peace [be] to people of good will.”

Solution I.16 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: I.16

Focus: Stem-first production and syntax-driven parsing

Use: Equivalent assessment with a different vocabulary set.

1. From *homo*, *hominis* m.; *civitas*, *civitatis* f.; *mors*, *mortis* f.; *sacerdos*, *sacerdotis* m.; *sanguis*, *sanguinis* m., derive each stem.

Answer / model: *homin-*, *civitat-*, *mort-*, *sacerdot-*, *sanguin-*.

2. Give accusative singular and plural, genitive plural, and ablative singular of *civitas*, *civitatis* f..

Answer / model: *civitatem*, *civitates*, *civitatum*, *civitate*.

3. Apply the neuter rule to *corpus*, *corporis* n.: give accusative singular, nominative plural, accusative plural, and genitive plural.

Answer / model: *corpus*, *corpora*, *corpora*, *corporum*.

4. Translate “the name of the king”, “peace to the people”, and “at the altars”.

Answer / model: *nomen regis*; *pax hominibus*; *in altaribus*.

5. Correct the two ending errors in *Lux perpetuum luceat eis*.

Answer / model: *Lux perpetua luceat eis*. *Lux* is feminine singular nominative, so *perpetua* agrees; *eis* is already the correct dative plural.

6. **Text:** *Introibo ad altare Dei, ad Deum qui lætificat iuventutem meam*.

Passage ID: I.16.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse *altare*, *Dei*, *Deum*, and *iuventutem*; resolve the case of *qui*; translate.

Answer / notes: *altare*: neuter singular accusative after *ad*; *Dei*: genitive singular; *Deum*: masculine singular accusative after *ad*; *qui*: masculine singular nominative subject of *lætificat*, with antecedent *Deum*; *iuventutem*: feminine singular accusative object. “I shall go unto the altar of God, to God who gives joy to my youth.”

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-I.4, *The Third Declension*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This packet teaches operational third-declension recognition; rare exceptions still require an identified lexicon.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-21T17:50:56Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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